there was quite a bit of volatility as well. From the level of about $35,000 on 11 January 2021, it touched $55,600 on 20 February 2021 rose to $63,000 in April, fell to less than $40,000 in September, rose again to $67,000–70,000 levels in October–November before ending the year at around $43,000. Bitcoin's market cap in March 2021 exceeded one-third of India's total GDP.

All currencies in the world are issued by sovereign or central banks, on behalf of the sovereign. Official/sovereign currencies carry a sovereign guarantee to pay equal value in gold or silver or simply fiat money. Private cryptocurrencies have no such guarantees. Central banks manage the issuance and circulation of money to maintain the value of official currencies. Issuers of cryptocurrency make no claim or effort to maintain the value of cryptocurrencies.

Most operating cryptocurrencies in the world have been created by private entrepreneurs/speculators by creating blocks of coins using blockchain technology in the distributed ledger technology (DLT) mode. There is no preassigned nominal or real value of private cryptocurrencies. Their prices fluctuate depending upon demand and supply. While there has been some use of cryptocurrencies in payments, including in international transfers, private cryptocurrencies have not been successful in becoming a significant means of payment primarily on account of a lack of fixed/stable value.

Blockchain technology can also be used by central banks to issue official currency. A few countries have initiated steps to develop models of official cryptocurrency but no central bank has launched one so far. The World Economic Forum and IMF have come up with some models of official cryptocurrencies under the broad rubric of 'Central Bank Digital Currency' or CBDT.

Facebook announced its intention to launch a stable cryptocurrency called Libra in 2019. It released a white paper in June 2019 and created an